

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

2024 Year-in-Review Evaluation
01/01/2024 to 12/31/2024
Document Status: Completed
Evaluated By MIN,STEVE KYUNG

Employment Details

Person Number	001572592	Department	150590 Streaming Kafka
Location	MN TELECOMMUTER	Division	46235 DV Chief Data Office (CDaO)
Job	Sr Software Engineer	Manager	MOCKUS,MICHAEL J

Overall Performance Rating

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Overall Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke is an amazing engineer who can tackle any problem. I believe he has the aptitude to do anything in our team space.

Complete or View Self-Reflection

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Reflecting on the goals you had for this year, what were your key accomplishments?

My biggest accomplishment this year has been the planning, oversight and execution of the GCP Kafka to HCP Console Migration. Although not yet completed, I have migrated 150 namespaces from legacy GitHub resource management to the UI in HCP Console. This has come with various challenges along the way, but I take pride in the fact that there has been zero negative production impact as a result of migration activity. From planning the automation to customer communications and finally into the execution of the namespace migrations themselves, I feel fulfilled for the first time as more than an individual contributor, but as a leader of one of our major efforts on the Kafka team.

1. Story Planning
 1. Throughout the year I have defined and detailed a couple

hundred user stories related to the migration effort. I was the main point of contact when it came to migration related questions, progress tracking and execution. While I myself needed to ask MANY questions to ensure my understanding of the underlying agents and infrastructure, I did compile all the information into executable user stories.

2. Customer Communications

1. We started this process with over 200 Individual namespace in gcp-kafka-prod. Each namespace housed a different number of resources, but the first step was to gather from all owners where they wanted resource to be migrated to (resource group collection) or in some cases even handle the decommission of their unused resources and namespace. This was a couple month long process and involved many individual follow-up conversations with teams.
2. The second major communication necessary throughout the process was the resolution of blockers. There were various blockers that different teams had, mainly related to resource configurations, that needed to be resolved before their namespace could be migrated. Each team with blockers (about 55 separate teams) needed special communication and detailed instructions from myself in order to resolve blockers.
3. pre-migration and post-migration emails were sent to customers to inform them of the migration starting and being completed. I have also continued to follow up in our support channels on any questions related to the migration of resources to help customers find and become comfortable with new resource management practices.

3. Development

1. Along with planning and customer communications, I also played a big role in writing the automation which is used to conduct the migration of each namespace. I did write a lot of the automation code, but I also had a ton of great help from other members of the team. When it wasn't me writing the code, I did review every PR that was merged into the migration automation myself and was responsible for testing all the functionality to ensure it was safe and would not result in any production impact.

4. Migration Execution

1. I have been responsible for conducting all of the completed namespace migrations to this point (150/172). This includes running the automation for each namespace and ensuring success through analyzing the detailed logs and checking cluster metrics to ensure health.

5. Progress Tracking

1. along the way I have been diligently tracking the migration progress as well as storing the important logs for the namespaces that have been migrated so that we can look back on them if/when that is necessary to assist customers in their new resource management processes.

While I do feel I played a major role in this entire effort, I do acknowledge that I could

not have done all of this without the help and support of this great team. When I have questions, they are always answered thoroughly and timely. The other engineers who helped in development did a terrific job and made the reviewing process both collaborative and smooth.

Miscellaneous Items:

- Contribution to our on-call rotations & chat support. I feel that my knowledge base is still continuing to grow. I am able to troubleshoot and resolve more and more issues without higher intervention. I am able to help customers in support channels with a wide range of issues/requests and have worked through support intakes to help our team best serve our customers. When I don't know an answer, I lean on other members of our team to help get the answers to provide resolution in a timely manner.

What challenges did you face and how did you develop?

Leading one of our team's big efforts has been both my biggest challenge and my biggest area of growth. Up until this year I have been mainly an individual contributor on well-defined milestones. I think being challenged in this way has given me a lot of confidence in my abilities.

1. Story Planning
 1. Learning how to create well-defined and focused stories was a bit of a challenge. Making sure the intent is clearly communicated, and the right number of helpful details are included, while leaving space for individual problem solving was a good stretch opportunity for me. Another challenge is/was estimating the overall time necessary to complete an effort as a whole. I find I often under-estimate the time things will take. I still have room to grow here, but with the experiences of the past year, I think I have become much better at planning in general.
2. Customer Communications
 1. I have enjoyed being able to communicate with so many new members of different teams. It is good to build those outside relationships, and I really can feel my network growing. I have learned valuable lessons in patience when asking for customers to take action and to be willing to give extra in depth help when needed. With the positives, have also come some challenges. The main one being getting responses from some teams. The main challenge has come in blocker resolution related to the GCP Migration. While some teams were very responsive and helpful, there were plenty that needed numerous reminders and

some white glove service. Communicating with so many customers has been a new experience, but I have learned valuable lessons throughout the process. Customer interaction and blocker resolution have probably been the biggest suppressor of velocity for the GCP Migration. However, it is more important that we take the time to correctly resolve blockers rather than forcing migrations through and causing production impact.

3. Tracking

1. Another big challenge with a task of this scale is simply keeping track of everything. I feel that I was forced to learn to be even more organized so that I could keep everything strait and give timely answers to questions asked.
 1. progress of automation development
 2. customer destination resource group gathering and namespace decommissions
 3. the nature of different namespace blockers, method of resolution and which namespaces are ready and safe to migrate
 4. working in tandem with EBaaS to ensure safe migration (and lack thereof) of namespaces using their product
 5. keeping track of the individual customer communications (1:1 and 1:many teams chats and email threads)
 6. status of the migration itself (how many namespaces are migrated and how many remain)
 7. log storage and backups in case of disaster

While I was able to handle a lot, I did need to lean on others for support in many ways throughout the process. In the future I will be quicker to leverage power on the team to expedite customer action when necessary. I also have room to improve in the way of delegation of certain tasks in order to expedite processes.

What do you want to continue to work towards in the coming year?

In the coming year I want to continue to grow as a leader on the Kafka team. I want to continue to learn and build an even deeper understanding of Kafka, our offerings and the public cloud in general. I want to continue to provide meaningful support to our customers and make the experience of using our platform easier and more understandable. Along with the customer focus, I want to continue to build on my ability to help collaborate and troubleshoot when issues arise in our own team's daily work.

A couple of concrete goals I can think of now for the coming year:

1. complete the migration of GCP Kafka to HCP Console

2. restart and complete my GCP Cloud Certification Course
3. start the next migration initiative (probably kaas-prod to HCP Console in one way or another) in order to further consolidate and modernize our offerings

2024 Goals

Deliver Quality the First Time, Every Time

Description I recognize that every moment and decision can offer an opportunity to put Quality first. I model behaviors consistent with our Values and Guiding Principles. I believe in improvement as well as getting it right the first time. I care about people and performance, making connections, building trust and taking individual ownership to grow together.

Success Criteria

Work with your manager on specific, quantifiable success criteria for you in your role. From there, you can identify 1) the actions you will take this year to focus on Quality and 2) how you will measure success.

[Review this guide](#) for information on creating success criteria for your Quality goal.

Status Not started
Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke has continued to deliver solutions to some of our most complex issues on the Kafka platform. He shows great aptitude for tackling multi-faceted problems, but also shows great enthusiasm for such tasks. The quality of the solutions are always on point and his

	contributions have been mission critical for the team as a whole.
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Delivery and Engineering Contribution

Description - 100% completion of work assigned in sprints

Team Health Volatility Trend Targets:
This is a calculated value from our sprints. To reduce this value, sprints need to have less stories going in/out mid-sprint. Essentially, better planning and predictability for sprints (reduce "churn").

- CLaaS Team: < 28% (Current at 31%)
- Kafka: < 33% (Current 36%)
- Meaningful GitHub commit(s)/changes every sprint
- PRs clearly documented and communicated for review
- Participation in PR review process
- 100% Demo participation
- Progress towards Cloud Migration effort
- Remediation of Critical/High Vulnerabilities and mindful effort in prevention of new vulnerabilities being added
- Mentorship and collaboration between team members, and engagement of "Knowledge Transfer" activities

Success Criteria

Status In progress

Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	3 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke frequently shares his technical grasp of the platform with other team members. He has taken time to learn the technical management of the Kafka team, and has been tapped to do "stand-in" team tech lead when needed. I would like to see continued growth on these aspects, and him increasing his influence on the team as a whole. In addition, I would like to see more experience in interacting with teams outside of our space/knowning when to escalate.

Operational Excellence

- Description
- Success in participation of team's on-call rotation and/or escalation policies
 - Reduce Total Alerts 15% by removing noisy alerts/non-meaningful alerts
 - On-call expectations
 - Alert Management
 - INC management, including war room documentation
 - Oncall Handoffs
 - Escalations properly and promptly when needed
 - +90% INC/PRB/War Room ticket closure within SLA
 - Support Intake Issue Closure/Response time
 - Change Requests for all impactful changes
 - Referencing and updating Ops Playbooks
 - Team wide Goal: HAD <https://had.optum.com/my/application>
 - Kafka Topics on Prem: >95% (Current: 94%)
 - Kafka Clusters on Prem: >95% (Current: 95%)
 - Kafka Clusters on GCP: >95% (Current: 80%)

Success Criteria

Status Not started

Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	5 - Exceeds Expectations
Comments	Luke's work has been heavily weighted to operational or operational adjacent tasks. He shows great ownership to how his work affects our customers as a whole and takes the extra effort to ensure the impact on customers is minimal. I believe Luke shows the greatest care for our customers on the entire team, and frequently steps in to assist when the Kafka team is not meeting customer obligations without question.

Employee Comments